

The children took their seeds and hurried home. They all got a pot, prepared some soil and sowed their seeds. The entire kingdom was excited. They were all **anxious** to see who the next king would be.

One of the finalists was Ani. The days stretched into weeks, but the seeds failed to sprout. Ani didn't know what had gone wrong. Ani and her parents were heartbroken. She had selected the soil with care, put the right manure, and very dutifully watered it. She had even prayed over it, day and night, and yet her seeds hadn't grown at all.

Some of her friends advised her to go and buy new seeds from the market and plant. After all, they said, "How can anyone tell if they were the same seeds?" Ani's parents had always taught her the value of honesty. They reminded her that if the king wanted them to plant just any wheat, he would have asked them to get their seed.

"If you use anything different from what the king gave, that would be dishonest. Maybe you're not **destined** for the throne. If so, let it be, but it would be wrong to cheat the king," they told her. Ani agreed.



It had been six weeks now. The much-awaited day had come. The children returned to the palace, each of them proudly carrying a pot of healthy seedlings. It was obvious that the other nine had great success with their seeds.

The king arrived. He was beaming looking at the children and their

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